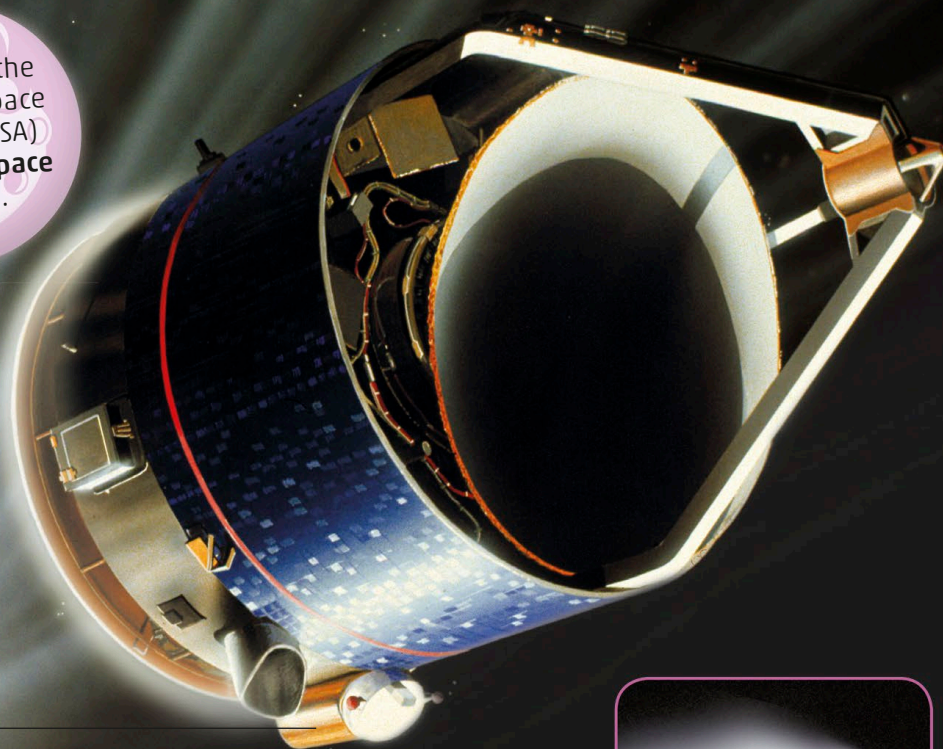


GIOTTO

Space probe

Giotto was the European Space Agency's (ESA) first deep-space mission.

The camera took 2,112 images of the comet's nucleus



Halley's nucleus as seen by Giotto

When Halley's Comet appeared in 1910, astronomers could only view it with telescopes. In 1986, however, the European Space Agency (ESA) flew a spacecraft called Giotto right through the comet's gaseous head, and took the first pictures of the icy nucleus at its centre. Giotto survived the flight, despite comet-dust hitting it at 100 times the speed of a bullet.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.85 m (9.4 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 2 July 1985



MISSION DURATION: 7 years, 21 days (deactivated)



SPACE AGENCY: ESA